

# German-French bargain on cars deadlocked

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## 【要点】

- ・ドイツとフランスが自動車の排出ガス基準と「メイド・イン・ヨーロッパ」要件に関する交渉で膠着状態に陥っており、両国は互いに譲歩できない立場を保っている。
- ・ドイツは「メイド・イン・ヨーロッパ」規則で業界寄りの妥協案を支持することを検討しているが、引き換えに自動車の排出ガス基準を弱めることを求めており、フランスはこれを受け入れる準備ができていない。
- ・ドイツの譲歩できない条件は、プラグインハイブリッド自動車の排出ガスを計算する「ユーティリティファクター」に関連しており、ラボデータと実際の使用状況の差が議論の焦点となっている。
- ・欧州クルーズ産業はブリュッセルと都市政府に対し、船舶への新税導入によって運航地域の変更を迫られる可能性があるかと警告している。
- ・EUは2027年下半年にReFuelEU航空改正案を提示予定であり、合成航空燃料のマンデート延期は除外されている。

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## 【メール原文】

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SNEAK PEEK

— The grand bargain between Germany and France over emission standards for cars and what qualifies as “Made in Europe” in the IAA has reached an impasse, with both sides digging in their heels.

— Europe’s cruise industry is warning Brussels and city governments that piling new taxes onto ships could eventually change where operators choose to sail —as the sector also presses the EU to rethink how its climate levies are used.

— The Commission expects to present its proposal on the revision of ReFuelEU Aviation in the second half of 2027, and has ruled out any postponement of the synthetic aviation fuels mandates.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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## DRIVING THE DAY

**FRENCH-GERMAN NEGOTIATIONS STALLED:** For months, Paris and Berlin have been in negotiations over a grand quid pro quo bargain on emission standards for cars and “Made in Europe” requirements in the Industrial Accelerator Act. The aim was to have the EU’s two biggest economies present a united front in Council discussions on the two files. But the two sides are now at an impasse, three people with knowledge of the negotiations told POLITICO.

**Catch up:** We scooped in July that Paris and Berlin were in negotiations that would see Germany agree to push for strengthening protections in the Industrial Accelerator Act in exchange for France dropping its opposition to softening emissions targets for automakers. The two files are key priorities for both capitals.

**Status update:** Berlin and Paris “remain quite far apart in their positions,” Gregor Williams, associate director at the Berlin-based think tank Rhodium Group, told Jordyn. Two other individuals also confirmed to POLITICO that the discussions have stalled. Germany is considering endorsing a compromise on the Made in Europe rules that would be closer to industry demands. But in exchange, Berlin wants to weaken car standards to an extent that Paris is not yet ready to accept, an industry executive with direct knowledge of the talks told our colleague Giorgio Leali, noting that “at the moment, negotiations are stuck.”

**Hard red line:** Germany’s red line on the emissions issue is the utility factor, perhaps the wonkiest topic to hold up political deliberations. The factor calculates the emissions from a plug-in hybrid vehicle based on how often a customer drives on the electric motor versus the combustion engine. The original utility factor was based on lab data, but real-world estimates show consumers drive on the combustion engine far more than anticipated. The Commission updated the factor to reflect the real-world data, with the new figure going into effect in 2027. Berlin wants a return to the lab-based standard, which would benefit its carmakers.

**Germany’s other priorities:** Berlin also wants additional concessions in the automotive package that proposed weakening the 2035 emission standards for automakers. While the Commission suggested lowering the emissions reduction target to 90%, instead of a de facto combustion engine ban, it requires automakers to offset the extra emissions with investments in alternative fuels and green steel. “There’s a lot of concern that these conditionalities are very stringent and hard to meet,” Williams said.

**Local content:** For its part, France wants stricter definitions of which countries would be included under the Industrial Accelerator Act’s “Made in Europe” banner. Wary of antagonizing its trading partners, Berlin is advocating for a “Made With Europe” approach that would make it easy for non-EU countries to be included, while Paris wants it limited to the bloc’s 27 member countries, and potentially extended on a case-by-case basis.

**Separate tracks:** The two countries are also negotiating a joint stance on tackling competition and on how to limit China dumping goods into the EU market. The discussions have been separated into two tracks, with one position paper focused on China and the other on the grand bargain on car emissions and the IAA.

**Bright spot:** Berlin and Paris are more closely aligned on China and are expected to send their joint paper to the European Commission later this week, Rhodium Group’s Noah Barkin said in a post on LinkedIn . The Commission is preparing its own package of trade tools to counter China, with October’s Council meeting expected to feed into the final proposal.

Hawkish stance: Germany has tended to take a more conciliatory approach to China, wary of provoking retaliation from Beijing against its automakers that would harm its export-driven economy. But with its auto industry now in crisis, Berlin's thinking has shifted. "The broader mood in Germany is something needs to be done," said Williams.

## MARITIME

**CRUISE LINES PUSH BACK ON EU TAXES:** Europe's cruise industry is warning Brussels and EU governments against levying new taxes on cruise ships, underlining that operators could end up changing where they sail.

Tax can change the itinerary: Bud Darr, CEO of the Cruise Lines International Association, told Martina that local taxes are becoming one of the industry's biggest policy headaches because even relatively small charges can tip a destination out of a cruise line's preferred itinerary. "Does it make it No. 11 on the 10 best choices if I have only 10 ships?" he said, adding that cruise itineraries are typically planned years in advance, so taxes introduced after tickets have been sold can become an irrecoverable cost — and may have a "chilling effect" on whether ships return.

Barcelona in focus: Darr pointed to Barcelona as a place the industry is watching over local tax plans. His preference is for some EU-level "guardrails" around how national and local authorities use that power — particularly around consultation, notice periods and whether charges relate to the burden cruise ships impose on a destination.

Tourism strategy next: CLIA is also waiting for the Commission's upcoming Sustainable Tourism Strategy . Darr said he expects it to focus more on guidance and funding than on launching a new regulatory regime, and said the industry believes some of its concerns will be addressed. The cruise lobby has already provided input to the Commission and wants to be involved in discussions over how tourism-related public money is spent, particularly where ports and cruise infrastructure are concerned.

ETS storm: Darr argued that money raised from shipping under the EU Emissions Trading System should be recycled into maritime decarbonization instead of flowing into general budgets. "The best use of that money that's coming from shipping ... is decarbonization of that sector," he said, pointing to fuels, technology and shipyards as areas where investment could make a difference. He also said that if a robust global climate framework is eventually agreed at the IMO, EU policymakers should consider rolling back or sunseting the maritime ETS.

China on the horizon: Europe still dominates cruise-ship construction, with around 98% of the value of the current global order book, stretching to about 2036, placed with European yards. But those yards are also backed up, which could create openings elsewhere. He warned that China has the technology, workforce and lower costs to catch up quickly if it seriously targets the market.

The warning to Europe: Cruise is one of the few shipbuilding segments where Europe still holds a commanding position, but Darr's message is that policymakers should not take that lead for granted while simultaneously raising operating costs and letting decarbonization revenues disappear elsewhere.

## AVIATION

**REFUELEU REVISION IN SECOND HALF OF 2027:** The Commission expects to present its proposal to revise the ReFuelEU Aviation regulation in the second half of 2027, Filip Cornelis, DG MOVE's director for aviation, said Monday. Speaking in the TRAN Committee in the European Parliament, Cornelis said the

“review and revision” of the file would serve a dual purpose: fixing what isn’t working “without, however, touching on the ambition of the regulation” and reducing the administrative burden.

What about e-SAF? On synthetic sustainable aviation fuels, or e-SAF, whose 2030 mandate is under fire from airlines, Cornelis said there are “around 50 projects in the pipeline, not yet reaching a final investment decision stage, but some of them are quite advanced in the design side.” He also said Germany, Austria and Luxembourg have committed to launching a pilot double-sided auction aimed at accelerating investment in e-SAF.

Mandates will stay: Responding to MEPs’ questions about e-SAF, Cornelis said that in the upcoming revision “we will repeat that we stand by the ambition. We can see the mandate is the right thing to do and is working ... and that will not be in our proposal next year.”

Claiming book-and-claim: TRAN MEPs also debated a draft report presented by Renew Europe’s Jan-Christoph Oetjen that supports the introduction of a book-and-claim mechanism for SAF.

**AIR TRAFFIC CONTROLLERS WARN OF RISKS FROM CONTRAIL AVOIDANCE:** Air traffic controllers are warning that measures to avoid climate-warming contrails could create operational problems, including delays and cancellations.

As we reported earlier, the Commission proposed in July to reward airlines that adopt measures to curb the non-CO2 effects from condensation trails, or contrails, which contribute to global warming alongside carbon emissions. Green NGO Transport & Environment, for example, has suggested that intervening on 3% of flights could prevent 80% of climate-warming contrails, implying that significant climate benefits could be achieved with relatively little effort.

Misleading narrative: The Air Traffic Controllers European Unions Coordination on Monday criticized such proposals. In a report, seen by Tommaso, it says they fail to consider the air traffic management perspective: “This could represent a major workload for a single air traffic en route center and create bottlenecks, rerouting, delays and cancellations across neighbouring airspace.” ATCEUC noted that 3% of European traffic amounts to around 1,080 flights a day. “ATCEUC’s understanding is that the need for additional resources is not properly quantified,” the document adds.

Who picks up the bill? Air traffic controllers stressed their support for operational trials to tackle contrails, but argued that “disruption must be assessed, including delays, cancellations, additional fuel consumption, passenger disruption,” as well as the additional resources required for air traffic management. That assessment should be made “keeping in mind that one minute of delay represents approximately €127 for each aircraft affected,” ATCEUC said.

## Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

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By Martina Sapio · Sept 28, 2026, 07:48 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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